

into the headphone. Now why would we want to do that? Most headphones try to reproduce sound as accurately as possible compared to speakers in a concert or a theatre. In such a setting the sound is three dimensional. The sound waves have a larger area to travel and the waves are dampened a bit by the air as a medium to avoid the sound from being too crude. When you're using headphones, the sound only travels from the drivers to the ear canal and the sound might be crude to the ears. By allowing the speaker drivers to breathe, the headphone create a more natural sound signature which helps in accurate reproduction of theatre or concert like settings. This concept is usually referred to as the sound stage. Recreating a sound stage accurately is the primary goal of any headphone manufacturer. Another reason why the open back headphones are better is because of the ambient noise. For many people, complete noise dampening or isolation can be disorienting and causes dizziness. To avoid this, a small amount of ambient noise is let in so that the sound is reproduced more accurately like a set of speakers.

Closed Back

While Open back headphones are good for accurate sound reproduction, closed back headphones are more practical. In day to day use for a casual user, there is too much ambient noise, be it the loud hum of trains or airplanes, incessant honking by disgruntled car drivers and babies crying on public transport and just annoying people in general. To block out all this, closed back headphones are the best. No consumer-grade headphone creates the perfect seal on your ears and some noise will always find its way into your ears when with the best of noise cancelling technology. Closed back headphones also provide protection against noise in windy environments which might make or break your musical rhapsodies.



Circumaural Open Back Headphones provide a better sound stage by allowing the sound to travel outside the ear cushions

Sound Channels

Coming to the electronics of headphones, there are two types: mono and stereo. Mono headphones reproduce the same audio signals in both the ear pieces. There is only one dimension in this type of audio signals and you cannot really distinguish the direction in which the sound is coming